

Mathematical Expectation:

The *average* value of a random phenomenon is also termed as its *mathematical expectation* or *expected value*.

The expected value of a discrete r.v. is a weighted average of all possible values of the r.v., where the weights are the probabilities associated with the corresponding values.

For a discrete r.v. X with p.m.f. $p(x)$,

$$E(X) = \sum_x x p(x)$$

For a continuous r.v. X with p.d.f. $f(x)$,

$$E(X) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x f(x) dx$$

Expected Value of a function of a random variable

Consider a r.v. X with *p.d.f. (p.m.f.)* $f(x)$ and distribution function $F(x)$.

If $g(\cdot)$ is a function such that $g(X)$ is a r.v. and $E[g(X)]$ exists, then

$$E[g(X)] = \sum_x g(x) p(x) \quad (\text{for discrete r.v.})$$

$$E[g(X)] = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} g(x) f(x) dx \quad (\text{for continuous r.v.})$$

Particular cases:

1. If we take $g(X) = X^r$, r - being a positive integer, then

$$E[X^r] = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x^r f(x) dx$$

$$E[X^r] = \sum_x x^r p(x)$$

Which is defined as μ'_r , the r^{th} **moment (about origin)** of the probability distribution. Thus

$$\mu'_r \text{ (about origin)} = E(X^r)$$

In particular, if $r = 1$ $\mu'_1 \text{ (about origin)} = E(X) = \bar{X} = \mathbf{Mean}$

$$r = 2 \quad \mu'_2 \text{ (about origin)} = E(X^2) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x^2 f(x) dx$$

$$\mu_2 = \mu'_2 - \mu_1'^2 = E(X^2) - [E(X)]^2$$

2. If $g(X) = E[X - E(X)]^r = E[X - \bar{x}]^r$, then

$$E[X - E(X)]^r = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} [x - E(X)]^r f(x) dx = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} [x - \bar{x}]^r f(x) dx$$

$$E[X - E(X)]^r = \sum_x [x - E(X)]^r p(x) = \sum_x [x - \bar{x}]^r p(x)$$

which is μ_r , the r^{th} **moment about mean**.

if $r = 2$, we get $\mu_2 = E[X - E(X)]^2 = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} [x - \bar{x}]^2 f(x) dx = \mathbf{Variance}$

3. If $g(x) = \text{constant} = c$,

$$E(c) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} c f(x) dx = c \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} f(x) dx = c$$

$$E(c) = \sum_x c p(x) = c \sum_x p(x) = c$$

Expected Value of Two-dimensional RV

If (X, Y) is a two-dimensional RV with joint *p.d.f.* $f(x, y)$ or joint *p.m.f.* p_{ij} , then

$$E[g(X, Y)] = \sum_i \sum_j g(x_i, y_j) p_{ij} \quad (\text{for discrete r.v.})$$

$$E[g(X, Y)] = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} g(x, y) f(x, y) \, dx dy \quad (\text{for continuous r.v.})$$

Properties of Expectation:

1. **Addition theorem of Expectation:** $E(X + Y) = E(X) + E(Y)$

Proof:

$$\begin{aligned} E(X + Y) &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} (x + y) f(x, y) \, dx dy \\ &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} (x) f(x, y) \, dx dy + \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} (y) f(x, y) \, dx dy \end{aligned}$$

$$E(X + Y) = E(X) + E(Y)$$

Generalisation: $E(X_1 + X_2 + \cdots + X_n) = E(X_1) + E(X_2) + \cdots + E(X_n)$

or

$$E(\sum_{i=1}^n X_i) = \sum_{i=1}^n E(X_i)$$

2. Multiplication theorem of Expectation:

If X and Y are independent random variables, then $E(XY) = E(X) \cdot E(Y)$

$$\begin{aligned} E(XY) &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} (xy) f(x, y) \, dx dy \\ &= \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} (xy) f(x) f(y) \, dx dy \quad [\text{Since, } X \text{ and } Y \text{ are independent}] \\ &= \left[\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x f(x) \, dx \right] \left[\int_{-\infty}^{\infty} y f(y) \, dy \right] \\ E(XY) &= E(X) E(Y) \end{aligned}$$

Generalisation: If $X_1, X_2, \dots, X_n$ are n - independent r.v.'s, then

$$E(X_1 \cdot X_2 \cdot \dots \cdot X_n) = E(X_1) \cdot E(X_2) \cdot \dots \cdot E(X_n)$$

or
$$E(\prod_{i=1}^n X_i) = \prod_{i=1}^n E(X_i)$$

3. If $\mathbf{X}$ is a random variable and $\mathbf{a}$ and $\mathbf{b}$ are constants, then

$$\mathbf{E}(\mathbf{aX} + \mathbf{b}) = \mathbf{a} \mathbf{E}(\mathbf{X}) + \mathbf{b}$$

Proof: $E(ax + b) = \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} (ax + b) f(x) dx$

$$= a \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} x f(x) dx + b \int_{-\infty}^{\infty} f(x) dx$$

$$E(ax + b) = a E(X) + b$$

If $b = 0$, then we get $E(aX) = a E(X)$

However,

$$E\left(\frac{1}{X}\right) \neq \frac{1}{E(X)}$$

$$E(X^{1/2}) \neq [E(X)]^{1/2}$$

$$E(\log X) \neq \log E(X)$$

$$E(X^2) \neq [E(X)]^2$$

Variance:

$$\text{Variance} = \text{Var}(X) = E[X - E(X)]^2 = E(X^2) - [E(X)]^2$$

1. If X is a random variable, then $V(ax + b) = a^2V(X)$

Proof:

Let $Y = aX + b$

$$E(Y) = E(aX + b)$$

$$= a E(X) + b$$

$$Y - E(Y) = (aX + b) - (a E(X) + b)$$

$$= a[X - E(X)]$$

$$E[Y - E(Y)]^2 = a^2 E[X - E(X)]^2$$

$$V(Y) = a^2V(X)$$

2. $V(b) = 0$, Variance of a constant is zero.

3. $\sigma = \sqrt{\text{Variance}} = \sqrt{\text{Var}(X)}$ = Standard Deviation.

Example 1

Let X be a random variable with the following probability distribution:

X	:	-3	6	9
$P(X = x)$	:	1/6	1/2	1/3

Find the values of $E(X)$, $E(X^2)$ and $E(2X + 1)^2$

Example 2

Find the expectation of the number on a die when thrown.

Example 3:

Two unbiased dice are thrown. Find the expected values of the sum of numbers of points on them.

Example 4:

A coin is tossed until a head appears. What is the expectation of the number of tosses required.

Co-Variance:

If X and Y are two random variables, then the covariance between them is defined as:

$$\begin{aligned} Cov(X, Y) &= E[\{X - E(X)\}\{Y - E(Y)\}] \\ &= E[XY - X E(Y) - Y E(X) + E(X)E(Y)] \\ &= E(XY) - E(X) E(Y) - E(Y) E(X) + E(X)E(Y) \\ Cov(X, Y) &= E(XY) - E(X) E(Y) \end{aligned}$$

If X and Y are independent random variables, $E(XY) = E(X) E(Y)$

and hence, $Cov(X, Y) = E(X) E(Y) - E(X) E(Y) = 0$

Properties:

$$\begin{aligned} 1. \quad \text{Cov}(aX, bY) &= E[\{aX - E(aX)\}\{bY - E(bY)\}] \\ &= E[a\{X - E(X)\} b\{Y - E(Y)\}] \\ &= ab E[\{X - E(X)\} \{Y - E(Y)\}] \end{aligned}$$

$$\text{Cov}(X, Y) = ab \text{Cov}(X, Y)$$

$$2. \quad \text{Cov}(X + a, Y + b) = \text{Cov}(X, Y)$$

$$3. \quad \text{Cov}\left(\frac{X - \bar{X}}{\sigma_X}, \frac{Y - \bar{Y}}{\sigma_Y}\right) = \frac{1}{\sigma_X \sigma_Y} \text{Cov}(X, Y)$$

4. If X and Y are independent, $\text{Cov}(X, Y) = 0$, but the converse is not true.

$$5. \quad V(X_1 \pm X_2) = V(X_1) + V(X_2) \pm 2\text{Cov}(X_1, X_2)$$

$$6. \quad V(\sum_{i=1}^n a_i X_i) = \sum_{i=1}^n a_i^2 V(X_i) + 2 \sum_{i=1}^n \sum_{j=1}^n a_i a_j \text{Cov}(X_i, X_j)$$

Correlation Coefficient:

If X and Y are two random variables, then the covariance between them is denoted as $Cov(X, Y)$,

$$Cov(X, Y) = E(XY) - E(X) E(Y)$$

and the Co-efficient of correlation (r_{XY} or ρ_{XY}) between X and Y is defined as ***a numerical measure of linear relationship between them***,

$$\rho_{XY} = \frac{Cov(X, Y)}{\sigma_X \sigma_Y} = \frac{Cov(X, Y)}{\sqrt{Var(x)} \sqrt{Var(y)}}$$

Properties:

1. If X and Y are independent, $Cov(X, Y) = 0$ and $\rho_{XY} = 0$ but the converse is not true.

When $\rho_{XY} = 0$, we say that X and Y are uncorrelated.

2. $|\rho_{XY}| \leq 1$

i.e., if $\rho_{XY} = +1 \Rightarrow$ Positive Correlation

$\rho_{XY} = -1 \Rightarrow$ Negative Correlation

$\rho_{XY} = 0 \Rightarrow$ UnCorrelated random variables.

Example 5: For a bivariate probability distribution of (X, Y) given below,

Y \ X	-1	0	1
-1	0	0.1	0.1
0	0.2	0.2	0.2
1	0	0.1	0.1

- Find
- (i) Show that X and Y are independent.
 - (ii) Find $Var(X)$ and $Var(Y)$.
 - (iii) Find $r(X, Y)$.

Example 6

Two random variables X and Y have the following joint probability density function:

$$f(x, y) = \begin{cases} 2 - x - y ; & 0 \leq x \leq 1, 0 \leq y \leq 1 \\ 0 ; & \text{otherwise} \end{cases}$$

Find

- (i) Marginal probability density function of X and Y .
- (ii) Conditional density function of X and Y
- (iii) $\text{Var}(X)$, $\text{Var}(Y)$ and $\text{Corr}(X, Y)$.